a battle and included this territory in the Mauryan conquered *vijita*.'[24] This, of course, is not enough, especially since no part of the emperor's message has any reference to or remembrance of the conquest of Karnataka. What is certain, though, is that Ranamandala revealed artefacts and antiquities which appear to be Mauryan, ranging from NBP sherds to a circular medallion bearing reliefs of standing mother goddesses flanked by trees and animals. These belong to the same family as those found at Mauryan sites in North India.[25] Another suggestion has been that the reason why Kalinga was not mentioned is that Ashoka *did* conquer Karnataka. What transpired in the Karnataka conquest was not comparable to Kalinga, but because this was a recently annexed region the emperor was being circumspect in omitting mention of warfare at Sannathi. This theory would also explain the omission of the Kalinga edict.[26]

A major problem with the Sannathi edicts as compared to those in Kalinga is that the slab-bearing part of Ashoka's message was not found *in situ*. When it was discovered it formed the pedestal of the idol of Kalikamba in the Chandralamba temple. This means that while it is likely to have been around the early historic city at Sannathi, or possibly in the vicinity of the Kanaganahalli stupa, we cannot be sure where it originally stood. From the perspective of imagining what the ancient landscape looked like, Orissa is easier to speculate on since the rescripts are exactly where Ashoka had them engraved. Unlike the Sannathi slab, which bears only part of the message, the Orissa edicts are fairly complete. This makes it possible to offer an imaginative yet historically grounded account of how political exigencies resulted in a changed royal message.

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In Orissa the process is especially clear because the edicts there have survived much better. At Dhauli and Jaugada, significant chunks of Ashoka's longer message were not inscribed, three edicts being omitted: